



EXPERTS AGREE THAT THE INDIGENOUS PEOPLES OF North

AMERICAN INDIANS

THE FIRST INHABITANTS OF THE US

America originally came from Siberia, trekking across an Ice-Age land bridge

BRAVE WORDS

The Navajo's language is vital to their culture. In World War II, Navajo radio operators used this language as a code, and the enemy never broke it. Here "code talker" Dan Akee displays his Congressional Medal of Honor.



Proud nations

Native Americans are usually categorized according to the regions they first settled: Plains, Northeastern Woodlands, Southwest, etc. Within each category, there are a number of separate groups, or nations. Across the country though, these groups are linked by a deep pride in their heritage and a fierce determination to keep their cultures alive.

PAINTING IN THE SAND

As part of their healing ritual, the Navajo people of the Southwest create delicate and beautiful sand paintings. Once, these were destroyed as soon as they were created, but now many are preserved, or their designs captured on special rugs and textiles.



HONORED CRAFT

Navajo textiles have been highly valued since the 19th century, and all the relevant skills and tools are passed down from mother to daughter. Typical blankets have strong graphic designs interpreted in bright colors.

Traditional Navajo houses are called hogans.

Navajo craftspeople make intricate silver-and-turquoise jewelry.

